

MEHNDI ARTIST MARKETPLACE

Product Idea & MVP Business Plan

Working concept: A marketplace where customers can discover, compare, request quotes from, and eventually book verified Mehndi artists.

Existing asset: Shiva Mehndi Art — the existing website/business can serve as the initial pilot and first verified artist.

Prepared: September 2026

1. Executive Summary

The idea is to evolve the existing Shiva Mehndi Art website into a launchpad for a larger Mehndi artist marketplace. The long-term product would connect customers looking for Mehndi services with independent artists, starting in Ahmedabad and expanding city by city.

The recommended strategy is **not** to immediately replace the existing Shiva Mehndi Art brand. Keep it as your wife's business and use it as the first marketplace participant. Validate the marketplace model before investing in a separate national brand.

Core customer promise: Find suitable Mehndi artists near your event, compare their profiles and pricing, request multiple quotes, and eventually book with confidence.

Initial monetization: Start with free artist listings and lead generation. Add booking commission and paid/featured artist plans after demand is proven.

2. Problem to Solve

- Customers often discover Mehndi artists through Instagram, Google, WhatsApp, referrals, or wedding groups.
- It is difficult to compare multiple artists on style, experience, location, pricing, reviews, and availability.
- Artists may have good work but limited online visibility and inconsistent lead generation.
- A marketplace can organize fragmented local supply and make the buying process easier.

3. Product Vision

Build a focused marketplace first for Mehndi artists, then potentially expand into adjacent services such as Mehndi classes, supplies, training, certification, and other wedding/event services.

Long-term positioning: **Find • Compare • Get Quotes • Book Mehndi Artists**

4. Recommended Business Model

Revenue stream	How it works	Priority
Paid leads	Artist pays for qualified customer enquiries.	★★★★★
Booking commission	Platform takes a percentage when a booking is completed.	★★★★■
Featured listings	Artist pays for enhanced visibility/profile placement.	★★★★■
Artist subscription	Monthly plan for extra leads, portfolio space and analytics.	★★★██
Courses	Sell Mehndi training/classes online or through artists.	★★███
Products	Sell Mehndi cones, kits, books and supplies later.	★★███

5. MVP: What to Build First

The first version should be deliberately small. The goal is to validate whether customers submit enquiries and whether artists respond to them—not to build a full marketplace on day one.

Feature	MVP requirement
Artist profiles	Name, photo, bio, city, experience, styles, services, pricing, WhatsApp/contact.
Portfolio	Multiple photos and selected work categories.
Search/filter	City, service, style, budget and basic availability.
Quote request	Customer submits date, location, service, guest count and budget.
Get 3 Quotes	Route a qualified enquiry to several matching artists.
WhatsApp flow	Simple customer/artist communication in the first phase.
Admin panel	Approve artists, manage leads, profiles, categories and reviews.
Verification	Verified artist badge based on manual checks.

6. Customer Flow

Step 1: Customer chooses city → Ahmedabad initially.

Step 2: Selects service → Bridal, Guest, Event, Engagement, Festival, etc.

Step 3: Enters date, event location, guest count and approximate budget.

Step 4: Platform recommends suitable artists.

Step 5: Customer chooses “Get 3 Quotes.”

Step 6: Matching artists receive the enquiry.

Step 7: Customer compares responses and contacts/chooses an artist.

Step 8: Later, platform adds online advance payment and booking confirmation.

7. Artist Flow

Artist → Create profile → Upload portfolio → Select services/styles → Set service area and pricing → Verification → Receive leads → Respond → Convert booking → Collect reviews.

8. Artist Profile Data Model

Field group	Examples
Identity	Name, profile photo, bio, years of experience
Location	City, areas served, travel radius
Services	Bridal, guest, engagement, baby shower, corporate, festival
Styles	Arabic, Rajasthani, Marwari, Indo-Arab, minimal, portrait, mandala
Pricing	Starting price, package range, per-person/artist pricing where applicable
Portfolio	Photos, captions, style/category tags

Field group	Examples
Trust	Verified status, ratings, reviews, completed bookings
Operations	WhatsApp, lead status, availability, subscription

9. Technology Architecture

A practical stack for an MVP, especially if you already work with modern JavaScript/PHP ecosystems:

- **Frontend:** Next.js / React
- **CMS/backend:** Payload CMS
- **Database:** PostgreSQL
- **Hosting:** Vercel or equivalent
- **Images:** Object storage such as Cloudflare R2
- **Payments later:** Razorpay or another India-focused payment provider
- **Communication:** WhatsApp-first workflow initially

Keep the architecture modular so a simple lead-generation MVP can later become a full booking marketplace.

10. Payload Collections — Suggested

- **Users** — admin, artists and customers
- **Artists** — public artist profile and marketplace settings
- **Services** — bridal, event, guest, classes, etc.
- **Styles** — Arabic, Rajasthani, minimal, portrait, etc.
- **Portfolio Items** — artist images and categories
- **Leads** — customer enquiry and matched artists
- **Quotes** — artist responses to leads
- **Bookings** — confirmed booking details
- **Reviews** — customer feedback
- **Subscriptions** — artist plan/status
- **Payments** — future advance payments and commissions

11. Domain & Brand Strategy

Recommendation: Keep **shivamehndiart.com** primarily as your wife's business website. Do not immediately convert it into the national marketplace brand.

For validation, the existing domain can include a marketplace experiment such as **/artists** or **/artists/ahmedabad**. If the marketplace proves traction, launch a separate marketplace brand/domain and keep Shiva Mehndi Art as one of the marketplace's verified vendors.

Why? “Shiva Mehndi Art” naturally sounds like an individual business. A neutral marketplace name will be easier to scale when hundreds of independent artists are listed.

12. Launch Strategy

Phase 1 — Ahmedabad pilot

- Use Shiva Mehndi Art as the first verified artist.
- Recruit approximately 10–20 additional artists.
- Offer free profiles initially.
- Launch artist discovery + enquiry + Get 3 Quotes.
- Measure leads, artist response rate and completed bookings.

Phase 2 — Gujarat

- Expand to Surat, Vadodara and Rajkot.
- Introduce featured listings and paid leads.

Phase 3 — India

- Expand to major wedding markets.
- Introduce online advance payments, booking protection and stronger verification.

13. Monetization Example

Illustrative scenario only — actual pricing should be based on validated conversion and customer acquisition costs.

Example	Calculation	Monthly revenue
Booking commission	100 bookings × ₹10,000 × 10%	₹1,00,000
Pro listings	100 artists × ₹499	₹49,900
Paid leads	300 leads × ₹100	₹30,000

14. What NOT to Build Initially

- Native mobile app
- Nationwide marketplace from day one
- Complex AI matching
- Full escrow/payment infrastructure
- Dozens of categories
- Large subscription system
- Complicated real-time availability engine

The MVP should prove the business before increasing technical complexity.

15. Key Metrics to Track

- Number of active artists
- Customer enquiries per month

- Percentage of enquiries matched to artists
- Artist response rate
- Quote-to-booking conversion
- Average booking value
- Platform revenue per booking
- Repeat/referral customers
- Customer acquisition cost
- Artist retention

16. Longer-Term Opportunities

- **Mehndi classes:** Beginner and professional training.
- **Artist certification:** Training + verified marketplace profile.
- **Mehndi supplies:** Cones, kits, books and practice materials.
- **Artist tools:** Lead management, calendar, pricing and customer CRM.
- **Wedding packages:** Match customers with multiple artists for large events.
- **Expansion:** Potentially extend the model into related wedding/event services after Mehndi is proven.

17. Recommended Next Step

Build a **small Ahmedabad marketplace MVP** inside the existing ecosystem first. Keep Shiva Mehndi Art as your wife's business and first marketplace vendor. The first measurable goal should be simple: **Can the platform consistently generate qualified customer enquiries for independent Mehndi artists?**

If the answer is yes, add paid leads, featured profiles and eventually booking commission. Once the economics work, create a dedicated marketplace brand and expand city by city.

One-line product definition: “A trusted marketplace that helps customers find, compare, get quotes from, and book Mehndi artists.”

This document is a product-planning concept, not a financial forecast. Pricing, commission rates, legal terms and payment workflows should be validated before launch.